

Reflecting on your own practice

Day 3 · Session 4 | Both sectors | Shared resource

Nothing you write on this sheet is collected, marked or seen by anyone else. It is useful only to the extent that it is honest — where you are unsure, mark the less flattering option.

Part 1 — Individual Self-Assessment

Think about the two exercises you ran today: the Job Grading negotiation this afternoon, and the Extracting Needs exercise this afternoon. For each statement, mark how often it described you TODAY — not how you negotiate in general, and not what you know you should have done.

Circle one for each — based on today only	Detail
I put a number or a specific demand on the table before the issue had been explored	Rarely Sometimes Often
I interrupted, or listened mainly for a gap in which to make my next point	Rarely Sometimes Often
I proposed a solution before I understood what was actually driving the other side	Rarely Sometimes Often
I argued with the other side's stated position rather than exploring what sat behind it	Rarely Sometimes Often
I lost track of my own priority order once the exchange became pressured	Rarely Sometimes Often
I conceded because the room felt uncomfortable, not because the argument persuaded me	Rarely Sometimes Often
I avoided the hardest item until the clock forced it onto the table	Rarely Sometimes Often
I discovered my own limits during the negotiation rather than before it	Rarely Sometimes Often
I asked a question and then filled the silence myself	Rarely Sometimes Often

Circle one for each — based on today only	Detail
I assumed I knew the other side's real need without testing it	Rarely Sometimes Often

Now add up nothing. There is no score. Instead, look back over the ten statements and underline the two or three that you marked most honestly and least comfortably.

Part 2 — Habit or Situation?

Not every obstacle you met today was about you. Some were features of the brief, the mandate, the clock or the counterpart you were given. These two kinds of obstacle need completely different responses, and confusing them is one of the most common reasons negotiators stop improving.

The test: would you have done the same thing on a different issue, with a different counterpart, on a different day? If yes, it is a habit. If no, it was the situation.

Sort the items you underlined

Item you underlined in Part 1	HABIT (about me) or SITUATION (about the brief)?
1	
2	
3	

If you marked SITUATION — what would the right response have been?

Situational obstacles do not yield to self-improvement. A fixed mandate is not solved by listening harder. What they need instead is a strategy: a different person in the room, a different timetable, more information, a narrower agenda, or an honest acknowledgement that today was not the day it would settle.

Question 1

For one situational obstacle you met today, what strategic response would have served you better than trying harder?

Part 3 — Your Priorities for Tomorrow's Sector Simulation

Tomorrow afternoon you negotiate in your own sector, on a scenario much closer to your working life. This is what you will take into that room.

A usable improvement priority passes five tests

It describes a behaviour, not an attitude — something a camera in the corner of the room could record.

It is small enough to do inside a single negotiation.

It has a trigger: when X happens, I will do Y.

You could tell in the moment whether you had done it — not only on reflection afterwards.

It is yours, not the one you think sounds impressive.

Weak: "Be a better listener." Strong: "When the other side names a figure, I will ask what is behind it before I respond."

Draft here

Priority	Write in the form: when X happens, I will do Y
Priority 1	
Priority 2	

Optional — say it out loud

If you choose, tell one colleague your two priorities and ask them to help you notice the triggers. Who did you tell? _____

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TAKE THIS INTO TOMORROW'S SIMULATION
My two priorities — Day 4 sector negotiation simulation
1. When
I will
2. When
I will